CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · NCERT-TYPE CHAPTER TEST SET 3

Chapter 15: **That Little Square Box** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. NCERT-type: questions in the style of the textbook examples and exercises.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. A 'lifeboat' is: 1

(a) a pirate ship **(b)** a small boat kept for emergencies
(c) a fishing boat **(d)** a cargo vessel

2. What do the men pour into the box? 1

(a) sand from the deck **(b)** paper
(c) water **(d)** whitish grains

3. The men were letting the pigeons go for a: 1

(a) gift **(b)** race **(c)** experiment **(d)** show

4. 'Countdown' means: 1

(a) counting money **(b)** a type of clock
(c) a list of names **(d)** counting backwards to an event

5. A sound the narrator hears from the box is: 1

(a) ringing **(b)** whistling
(c) clicking **(d)** ticking of a clock

6. The man whose pigeon reaches land first is: 1

(a) Flannigan **(b)** the narrator **(c)** the sailor **(d)** the captain

7. A 'secretive' person: 1

(a) is lazy **(b)** talks a lot
(c) is friendly **(d)** hides information

8. The men speak of 'letting it off'. The narrator interprets this as: 1

(a) releasing a rope **(b)** firing a salute
(c) opening a window **(d)** setting off an explosion

9. The race is kept secret because: 1

(a) the box is fragile
(b) captains have a prejudice against such sports aboard ships
(c) pigeons are poisonous
(d) it is illegal to carry pigeons at sea

10. The word 'suspicious' means: 1

(a) sleepy **(b)** feeling that something is wrong

(c) famous **(d)** joyful

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. What does the story show about jumping to conclusions? 2

12. What did the men pour into the box? 2

13. What was actually inside the box? 2

14. Explain the meaning of 'secretive' with a sentence. 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Describe the narrator's feelings in the lifeboat. 3

16. Write a note on the title 'That Little Square Box'. 3

17. How does the ending change the mood of the story? 3

OR

How does the men's reaction show the story's humour? 3

18. What lesson does the narrator learn? 3

OR

Write a short note on Flannigan's pigeon. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. 'Appearances can be deceptive.' Discuss with reference to the story. 5

OR

Describe the setting and how it adds to the story. 5

20. Describe the role of humour in the story. 5

OR

Imagine the narrator tells the captain about his fears. Write a possible dialogue. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND